

Samsung Galaxy A35

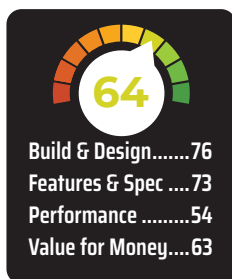
Reliable and polished but not for gamers

The Samsung Galaxy 'A' series is one of the most coveted series of smartphones in the mid-range to high-end segment. This is not surprising given Samsung's popularity in India and the trust consumers have pertaining to the quality of Samsung phones. The yearly refresh of the A series has hit the market with two fresh offerings – the Samsung Galaxy A55 and the Samsung Galaxy A35. I am reviewing the latter, the Galaxy A35 which is priced starting at ₹30,999. Notably, the Galaxy A35 makes some improvements in the processor and camera departments, however, it goes for the "if it ain't broke" policy in the display and battery areas. Given that many areas see minimal improvement, is it a worthy upgrade? Also, how will the Samsung Galaxy A35 fare against its fiercest competitors such as the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Redmi Note 13 Pro+? Let's delve into that and more in my Samsung Galaxy A35 review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Samsung Galaxy A35 is designed like your typical mid-ranger – a plastic frame sandwiched between two glass slabs. However, some subtle design flourishes make it appear more premium than its price. For instance, Samsung has swapped out Gorilla Glass 5 protection in favour of the much more durable Gorilla Glass Victus+ protection on the front. The back panel looks minimalist and classy, aping the look of Samsung's flagship S24 pretty convincingly.

The triple camera setup is housed in individual rings, much like the Galaxy A55 and Galaxy S24. There's a nonde-



script Samsung logo at the bottom that doesn't pull too much attention. The phone is available in three colourways – Iceblue, Lilac, and Navy. I got the Lilac variant for review and it is a lovely pastel colour that's rare to find at this price point. The back attracts fingerprints but the sheen of the rear panel takes your attention away from those.

The plastic frame has a nice matte finish that looks deceptively like the aluminium frames on more expensive Samsung phones. The subtle contours and indents in the frame make it comfortable to hold as well. The buttons are incredibly well-built and sufficiently tactile. Moreover, the phone is equipped with a great stereo speaker system, IP67 dust and water resistance, and a speedy in-display fingerprint sensor.

DISPLAY

Up front, the Samsung Galaxy A35 sports a 6.6-inch display nestled into

somewhat thick bezels. This can be a turn-off for some as competition such as the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ has comparatively slimmer bezels. However, the Galaxy A35 does make a massive improvement. The dated U-shaped notch that plagued the A34 last year has, thankfully, disappeared. That aside, there are no real improvements in the display department.

You've got the same 6.6-inch Super AMOLED display with Full HD+ resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate. The rated brightness is unchanged at 1,000 nits (on High Brightness Mode). Once again, there's no HDR support on the display. This is very disappointing given that the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Redmi Note 13 Pro+ come packing this feature.

Complaints aside, this is still a gorgeous display – one of the best at its price point. It's crisp, vibrant, and has excellent viewing angles. HD content on YouTube and Netflix looks fantastic with deep blacks and great clarity. Screen legibility in harsh sunlight is satisfactory as well. In my tests, I got a reading of 882 nits under harsh sunlight with Adaptive Brightness active.

PERFORMANCE

If you're not a gamer, the Samsung Galaxy A35's performance isn't going to leave you underwhelmed. It has an upgraded 5 nm Exynos 1380 chipset that outperformed the Dimensity 1080 chipset on its predecessor in pretty much every metric. You also get 8 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and up to 256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage. Unfortunately, the A35's data transfer speeds are quite lacklustre; pretty much all of its competitors doubled or tripled its read and write speeds.

Nevertheless, the phone is smooth in day-to-day operations. One UI 6.1 is beautifully optimised; animations are ridiculously smooth and there are little to no instances of lag or stutter, even when multitasking. Apps such as YouTube, Netflix, WhatsApp, Instagram, and others run fluidly; and gaming is also not a bad experience. I could play Call of Duty: Mobile on Medium